

A band's royalties: paid right, split right?

Half a year of a synthetic band: distributor statement, bank account, split sheet

REPORTED BY THE STORES	ARRIVED IN EUROS	PAID TO THE FOUR
\$8,717.02	€7,884.53	€6,560.23

Every reported dollar reached the account. Five things did not go as they should:

What	Where	Amount
A month never reported	Apple Music, February sales, every track	≈ \$467
A month reported twice	Deezer, February sales, April and May statements	+\$95.15
Streams taken back as artificial	Spotify, Summer Static, March sales	-\$191.52
Conversion beyond the agreed margin	Withdrawal of 29 May, 3.1% below reference	-€19.03
Manager's commission above the contract	30 April withdrawal: 20% instead of 15%	-€141.63

From the stores to the members, EUR

	EUR
Withdrawn, \$8,717.03 converted	7,884.53
Manager's commission, of which €141.63 above the contract	-1,324.31
Paid to the four members	-6,560.23
Left in the account	-0.01

At the day's reference rates the withdrawals would have brought €7,975.87; the bank kept €91.34, €19.03 of it beyond the agreed margin.

Who is owed what

Member	Owed	Paid	Difference
Mara Keller	2,073.84	1,989.58	-84.26
Jonas Brandt	2,058.03	1,984.21	-73.82
Teo Vasić	2,058.03	1,984.21	-73.82
Lena Ortiz, producer	511.95	602.23	+90.28
Together	6,701.85	6,560.23	-141.62

The first quarter was paid exactly as owed. In the second the manager took 20% of the April withdrawal, which is what the four are short together, and the single was shared out on the album's split, paying the producer 10% of a track she is not on.

What the band does next

- Ask the distributor about Apple Music's February.
- Keep \$95.15 aside for Deezer's double.
- Find out who promoted Summer Static in March.
- Ask the manager to return €141.63 and the producer €90.28; pay the three what they are owed.
- Ask the bank about the rate of 29 May.

Synthetic data. The statement is modelled on a distributor's detailed download; its columns are illustrative. Six planted disagreements, all found with the right store, month, track and amount, by code written by whoever planted them: this shows the method, not a blind test.